LYNX Marks 23rd Public Service Bus Unveiling at Orlando City Hall

The Central Florida Regional Transportation Authority (LYNX) unveiled its 2026-27 Public Service Bus during a ceremony held May 26 at Orlando City Hall Plaza in downtown Orlando. The annual initiative provides free exterior bus advertising to eight nonprofit organizations serving Orange, Osceola and Seminole counties.

Now in its 23rd year, the Public Service Bus program gives smaller nonprofits an opportunity to expand awareness across the region through yearlong exposure on a 40-foot LYNX bus traveling throughout the service area. This year's group of winners join more than 200 nonprofit organizations that have been featured through the program. Selected organizations must maintain 501(c)(3) status and operate with annual budgets under $1.5 million. This year's theme, "Together for a Better World", reflects the campaign's mission to help organizations connect with potential volunteers, donors and individuals in need.

The event featured remarks from LYNX Chief Executive Officer Tiffany Homler Hawkins and Orlando Mayor and LYNX Chair Buddy Dyer, who recognized the work local nonprofits perform every day across Central Florida. Orlando City Commissioner Shan Rose, representing District 5, also attended the unveiling and joined community leaders, nonprofit representatives and guests gathered at the plaza for the celebration.

Following the remarks, attendees observed the unveiling of the covered bus, which displayed the logos of the eight selected organizations. Representatives from each nonprofit posed for group photos alongside the vehicle and received framed images commemorating their participation in the program. Winners can also stage the bus at a future event of their choice within a year of the unveiling date.

Organizations featured on the 2026-27 Public Service Bus include Center for Change, Chance 2 Dance, Children's Safety Village of Central Florida, Edible Education Experience doing business as The Kitchen House, First Nature Foundation, Glorious Hands Inc., Loving Hearts & Praying Hands and Victoria Helping Veterans Inc.



LYNX Chief Executive Officer Tiffany Homler Hawkins, Orlando Mayor and LYNX Chair Buddy Dyer, Orlando City Commissioner Shan Rose and representatives from the eight winning nonprofit organizations selected for the 2026-27 Public Service Bus.

FPTA/FTAFC 2026 Scholarship Recipient! Congratulations to Chinonso Job Okorie



The Florida Public Transportation Association (FPTA) and the Florida Transit Association Finance Corporation (FTAFC) have awarded our 2026 scholarship to Chinonso Job Okorie. The scholarship was created to provide $5,000.00 to an individual who is interested in a career in public transportation in hopes to increase those interested in transit as a career. Our 2026 recipient is Chinonso Job Okorie, who is a student at the FAMU-FSU College of Engineering, studying Industrial Engineering.

Mr. Okorie is sponsored by the Jacksonville Transportation Authority and has been actively engaged with the Fare Capping Research Lab, a collaborative initiative with the University of North Florida and FAMU. From when the project kicked off in Fall 2024, he contributed significantly as a graduate student researcher under the supervision of his research advisor Dr. Yanshuo Sun. He also demonstrated strong technical capability and deep commitment to advancing data-driven solutions in public transportation.

As he continues to pursue his career goals, he states that he is interested in pursuing a career in the Planning and Design segment of public transportation, where transit agencies determine which routes serve communities, how transit networks expand, and what service levels reach different neighborhoods.

Congratulations to Chinonso Job Okorie!

FPTA Marketing Awards (cont. from page 1)

- **Best Ridership or Sales Marketing – Class 3**
  - Flex Zones 1 & 2
  - Bayway
- **Best Educational Initiative Marketing – Class 1**
  - PSTA's Table Book
  - Pinellas Suncoast Transit Authority (PSTA)
- **Best Educational Initiative Marketing – Class 2**
  - 321Transit App
  - Space Coast Area Transit / Brevard County BoCC
- **Best Educational Initiative Marketing – Class 3**
  - Music on the Move
  - Bayway

